The 6:15

WEDNESDAY · OCTOBER 14, 2026 NO. 25

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Today	8:30a ET: September CPI (BLS) — headline event of the day, not yet out as of this writing. Morgan Stanley, Bank of America and BlackRock report Q3 (confirmed).
Thu 10/15	8:30a ET: September PPI, advance retail sales, initial jobless claims (wk. ended 10/10) **(consensus ~0.3% retail sales m/m, ~0.5% PPI, ~197k claims — secondary-source calendars, not a wire survey)**.
~Tue 10/20	Netflix Q3, consensus EPS ~$0.82-0.84 **(date itself is a data-provider estimate, not confirmed by Netflix)**.
Sat 10/24	Northwestern hosts Rutgers, Ryan Field.
Standing	FOMC Oct. 27-28 (cut odds still in the teens-to-20s by prediction markets, near the cycle low); OPEC+ next meets Nov. 1; Nov. 3 midterms (Trump's self-imposed no-strike-on-Iran deadline); Dec. 11 FY2027 funding deadline, now resolved via an enacted stopgap rather than live risk **(continuity, retiring this thread)**; no frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run — fourth straight issue skipping this sub-bullet rather than padding it.

METRICS · ~6:10A ET UNLESS NOTED; NO ICE/NYMEX SETTLE YET PRE-NY-OPEN

Oil / rates / dollar	Brent $106.2-$106.4 across feeds **(Yahoo BZ=F $106.36 +0.63% at 6:09a; straits.live header $106.21 +1.20%/24h at 10:17 UTC vs. its own body text citing $105.40 at 09:04 UTC — not reconciled)**, up from Fri. 10/9's $104.72 settle; WTI $95.21 (+1.14%, Nov. contract, Yahoo, 6:09a); spread ~$11.1, narrowed from ~$12.9 on 10/9. 2Y

	4.79% / 10Y 5.21% / 30Y 5.56% (Treasury.gov daily yield curve, Tue 10/13 close — today's not yet posted); DXY 102.24 (+0.06%, 6:09a).
Equities / vol / gold / gas	S&P 500 futures 7,870.50 (+0.19%), Nasdaq 100 futures 30,767.50 (-0.08%), both 6:09a; VIX 15.23 (-0.26%, 6:03a); gold (Dec. future) $4,166.80 (-0.25%, 6:09a); AAA national retail gas $4.3333/gal today, down from $4.3669 on 10/9.
Asia closes / Europe	Nikkei 225 67,744.29 (-0.05%); Hang Seng 24,314.17 (-0.13%) **(Yahoo's own change figure doesn't tie to its stated prior close)**; Shanghai Composite 3,767.23 (-0.88%). Europe still mid-session, not closed: FTSE 100 10,699.40 (+0.46%), DAX 25,407.66 (+0.58%), CAC 40 7,873.30 (+0.58%), all ~11a-12p local.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Status	"Closed" to commercial shipping per straits.live's war-risk framing, Day 227 **(single-sourced framing)**.
Transits	4 on Oct. 4 vs. 85/day pre-crisis baseline (IMF PortWatch) **(same figure as issue No. 24; now 10 days stale)**.
Strikes	UKMTO reports two more strikes in the past 9h this morning (straits.live). This week: six vessels struck Oct. 11 — five tankers, one container ship, UKMTO warnings 164-26 through 169-26 (gCaptain). Oct. 13: a container ship and a tanker struck by unknown projectile; Iran's military separately claims the tanker hit a mine **(cause disputed, Gulf News/TASS/Fox)**. An IRGC claim that a 2,500-plus-container carrier sank after striking a mine is state-media-only, unconfirmed.
Dark tankers / war-risk	48 AIS-dark in the last 24h vs. a 79.0 7-day baseline (straits.live) **(a floor, not a verified evasion count — non-tankers went dark at 30.6% in the same window)**. War-risk ~$10.0M per VLCC transit, ~30x pre-crisis **(unchanged figure, now 20 days stale)**. Crisis Pressure 88 (±7) "extreme,"

	unchanged; Escalation Forecast 61 (±11) "high," up from 60 in issue No. 24.

Methodology: transits (PortWatch, lagged by design), strike counts (UKMTO/press aggregation, overlapping but not identical windows), and insurance premia (periodic underwriter indications, now stale) measure different things over different periods; never averaged or differenced here. All straits.live figures single-sourced.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated Oct. 7, swept by the Rays **(continuity)**.
Knicks	Preseason continuing; last confirmed record 0-2. Games vs. Minnesota (10/12) and Toronto (10/13, 10/15) not verified this run.
Northwestern	Beat Ball State 45-14 Oct. 10 at Ryan Field; now 4-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten. Hosts Rutgers Oct. 24.

LEAD

SAUDI ARABIA · HOUTHIS · OIL

Houthi missiles shut Riyadh's main airport and reach into Aramco's Eastern Province — oil starts pricing a war that has moved past Hormuz

A Houthi missile struck Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport on Saturday, Oct. 10, killing at least 12 people and wounding more than 300, per Saudi Arabia's General Authority of Civil Aviation; a later CBS/AP account puts the toll at 13 dead and over 300 wounded. [NEW, fact/flag, casualty count varies by source] The airport's closure, first ordered that day, was still in force as of Monday. [fact] The Houthis, who claimed responsibility Sunday, did not stop there: Tuesday brought fresh strikes on Abha and Riyadh airports that Saudi authorities say killed three and wounded 36, plus debris from two intercepted missiles that injured four more people and damaged 15 homes in Riyadh's residential districts. [fact] Wednesday — today — a Houthi strike reportedly hit an Aramco building in the

kingdom's Eastern Province, with Saudi authorities reporting four wounded; the Houthis say operations against Saudi airports and oil facilities will "continue in the coming days." [NEW, fact, single-sourced via live wire coverage this morning] The aviation fallout is real and ongoing: Saudi civil aviation has the airport's closure running at least through Oct. 17 by NOTAM, Lufthansa has cancelled Riyadh service to Oct. 16, Air France-KLM has extended its suspension to month-end, flydubai's cancellation runs to today, and Delta has pushed the planned launch of its new Atlanta-Riyadh route from Oct. 23 to March 2027. [fact, dates vary slightly by outlet, not reconciled] Over a third of Saudi Arabia's scheduled flights were cancelled Monday alone, per Khaleej Times. [fact, single-sourced]

This did not start unprovoked. The Saudi-led coalition struck Houthi positions in Sanaa on Oct. 3-4, and the Houthis claim — unverified, via their own state media — that Saudi forces carried out 106 strikes on Yemen in a single 24-hour window; the coalition calls the Houthis' Riyadh-strike narrative "misleading" and says it is cover for the group's own losses. [fact/flag, claims from both sides uncorroborated by a neutral source] What's not in dispute: Saudi Arabia has opened an investigation into why its air defenses failed to intercept the Oct. 10 barrage, and has vowed to respond "firmly." [fact] The Houthis, for their part, are threatening to widen the target list to Aramco's Dammam headquarters if Saudi strikes on Sanaa continue, and say the US will be targeted too if it joins Saudi operations. [fact]

That threat lands inside an already-tense US-Iran standoff: Washington has a third carrier converging on the region (per Oct. 1-2 reporting, no update located this run), and Trump has told Houthis

directly in recent days that Iran is "behaving very badly," while separately telling an Ohio rally crowd the US may have "gone too far" in killing Iranian regime leaders earlier in the war — the first public second-guessing of that tactic reported here. [NEW, fact] He has also said, contrary to reports of a Chinese and Russian intelligence role in attacks on US troops, that he does not believe either country is helping Iran, calling it bad for their own interests. [fact] None of this touches his Oct. 8 pledge to hold off on new Iran strikes until after the Nov. 3 midterms, which still stands.

Read: the Hormuz counters on the Board — dark-tanker counts, transit data, war-risk premia — are all measuring a chokepoint-and-insurance story that's days to weeks stale by design. What moved oil this week is a different, more acute risk: a direct hit on Saudi civil aviation and, now, Aramco's own real estate, even though reported damage so far has been described as limited and no production outage has been confirmed. [read] Brent has risen from Friday's $104.72 settle to the $105-106 range this morning, and WTI has moved more — from $91.85 to $95.21, nearly 4% in five sessions — narrowing the Brent-WTI spread by about $1.75. [fact] That's a market starting to price supply-side risk at the source rather than only at the strait. [read] Worth flagging against the tape: Trump said Oct. 6 the Iran war "could end soon" and predicted consumer prices would "come tumbling down" as a result — oil has instead risen across the five sessions since. [fact/read, gap between stated expectation and market reaction] Watch: today's CPI print competing for the tape's attention at 8:30a; whether Saudi's "firm" response escalates the Yemen side of this war further; and whether a Houthi strike on US assets or personnel would force Washington's hand before its own self-imposed Nov. 3 marker.

ECONOMICS

September CPI lands at 8:30a ET today, the week's main scheduled catalyst and not yet out as this issue goes to press. [fact] Pre-release consensus is inconsistent across sources — some put headline at 3.6% y/y with core 2.5%, others 3.7% headline with core 2.4% — none of it a wire-service survey, so treat the range, not a single number, as the estimate. [flag] PPI, advance retail sales and initial jobless claims (week ended Oct. 10) follow Thursday, also at 8:30a. [fact] Fed-cut odds for the Oct. 27-28 FOMC meeting remain low by prediction-market pricing — readings cluster in the teens-to-20s, consistent with the cycle low flagged in prior issues — though the underlying markets are thinly traded and the readings aren't fully consistent with each other. [flag] Separately, the University of Michigan's October survey put year-ahead inflation expectations at 4.7% and the five-year view at 3.5% — sentiment, not a government print. [fact/flag]

BUSINESS

Q3 bank earnings opened Tuesday with a split verdict. Wells Fargo beat: $6.0bn net income, $1.87 diluted EPS against a $1.85 estimate, revenue $21.87bn versus $21.44bn a year earlier. [fact, SEC 8-K] JPMorgan missed: diluted EPS $5.57 against a roughly $5.90-5.94 consensus, on revenue of $50.17bn and net income of $15.3bn — down from $21.2bn in Q2, which had included a one-time $4.6bn Visa-related gain that didn't repeat. [fact, SEC 8-K] Goldman Sachs and Citigroup also reported Tuesday; their actual prints were not verified this run, only pre-report estimates (GS ~$15.05 EPS, C ~$2.73 EPS). [flag] Today brings Morgan Stanley (consensus ~$3.12-3.13 EPS vs. $2.11 a year ago), BlackRock (~$14.25-14.30

vs. $11.55) and Bank of America (~$1.10, single-sourced this run) — all estimates, none reported as of this writing. [fact/flag]

GEOPOLITICS

The Riyadh-Sanaa exchange covered in the Lead sits inside a broader Saudi-Houthi air war that has run hot since early October: Saudi-led coalition strikes hit Houthi positions in Sanaa Oct. 3-4, and by Oct. 8-9 the coalition said it had intercepted two ballistic missiles headed for Riyadh, with intercept debris damaging a kindergarten and a medical complex. [fact] Houthi media claims of 106 Saudi strikes in 24 hours and of precision hits on Aramco infrastructure have not been independently corroborated, and the Saudi coalition disputes the framing outright. [flag, claims on both sides are state/proxy-sourced] No fresh, dated reporting on Russia-Ukraine was located this run **(gap, not filled from memory)**; OPEC+'s Nov. 1 review remains the next scheduled decision point on output, unchanged since its Oct. 4 hold.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Board's strike count, Tuesday's Hormuz incidents carry a specific wrinkle the Board couldn't fit: Iran's military claims the tanker struck Oct. 13 actually hit a naval mine rather than a projectile, directly contradicting the UKMTO/Gulf News account of an unknown-projectile strike — a dispute over mechanism, not just source count, that this brief is not in a position to resolve. [fact/flag] Straits.live's own morning brief adds an unconfirmed IRGC claim that a container ship carrying more than 2,500 boxes sank after a mine strike; no independent outlet has corroborated a sinking. [NEW, flag, single-sourced]

On diplomacy: Araghchi's "definitive" response to Washington's counterproposal, promised as imminent in issue No. 24, has not

surfaced in verified reporting this run — a gap, not a resolution. [flag] What is confirmed is Trump's posture this week: telling reporters Monday he doesn't believe China or Russia are supplying Iran despite pressure from reports of intelligence-sharing for attacks on US troops, and telling an Ohio rally crowd the US may have "gone too far" in killing Iranian leaders — notable as the first public walk-back-adjacent comment on that tactic reported in this brief. [NEW, fact] Neither statement changes the Oct. 8 pledge to hold off new strikes until after Nov. 3, which itself followed an Oct. 7-8 CNBC report, sourced to unnamed officials, that Trump said he didn't want an Iran deal even as the US was reportedly preparing for "massive bombing" if talks collapsed — the same tension between stated restraint and prepped escalation that runs through this week's carrier and Pentagon-directive threads. [fact, single-sourced via CNBC]

On the insurance and tanker-supply side, the vendors keep measuring different things: Breakwave's most recent published read (Sept. 8, now over a month stale) put Hormuz war-risk indications at 7.5%-12.5% of hull value per transit versus about 0.25% pre-crisis, and noted some underwriters had cut capacity or stopped writing cover entirely — a percent-of-hull-value metric, not comparable to straits.live's dollar-per-VLCC figure on the Board, and this brief will not convert between them. [fact, stale] Signal Ocean's tanker-positioning data (week of July 15, also stale) had VLCC ballasters in the Arabian Gulf at 115, down from a roughly 150 peak in March. [fact, stale] Separately, OFAC issued an Aug. 24 alert on sanctions risk tied to Hormuz passage payments, applying the warning to non-US entities as well. [fact, stale] None of this has been refreshed by a primary source this run; it's carried as background, not news.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; eliminated Oct. 7, swept by Tampa Bay in the ALDS.
Knicks	Preseason ongoing, last confirmed mark 0-2; results from games vs. Minnesota and Toronto this week not verified this run.
Northwestern	Beat Ball State 45-14 at Ryan Field Oct. 10; 4-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten; hosts Rutgers next, Oct. 24.

Continuity. The Dec. 11 FY2027 funding thread is retired: the stopgap (P.L. 119-103) is law, so this was tracked risk, not news, and won't recur unless the Dec. 11 deadline itself becomes live again. Politics and Technology are cut entirely — no fresh, independently verified item in either lane this run, fourth straight issue with nothing confirmed on frontier AI, rocket launches or VC mega-rounds. The carrier-buildout and Iran-nuclear-diplomacy threads from issue No. 24 carry forward unchanged except where noted above (Trump's new remarks); OPEC+ and the transit baseline are unchanged since Oct. 4 and are not re-adjectived here. Watch for next issue: Saudi Arabia's promised "firm" response to the Houthis; whether Aramco reports any confirmed production impact; today's CPI and tomorrow's PPI/retail-sales/claims trio; Knicks preseason results.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. Single- or state-sourced this issue: all Houthi casualty/strike-count claims and the Saudi coalition's rebuttal; the IRGC mine/sinking claim; the Oct. 13 mine-vs-projectile dispute; all straits.live Hormuz figures (status framing, dark-tanker floor, war-risk premium, Crisis Pressure/Escalation Forecast scores); Fed-cut-odds prediction-market readings; Goldman Sachs and Citigroup's actual Q3 prints (only pre-report estimates found); Knicks results from 10/12, 10/13 and 10/15; the Netflix earnings date. Brent's $105.40-$106.36 morning range and Hang Seng's internally inconsistent change figure are not reconciled. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.